



▲ What's inside the box



▲ Home screen

shop in the Android Market, which hosts heaps of little programs that give the phone even more power. Fortunately, many of the apps in the Android Market are free, and it is easy to download and install everything from Spotify to Skype.

HTC has also iced the Android cake with its Sense user interface—the same one as on the HTC Hero that I raved about, back in November. There are seven home screens, which you can customise to your heart's delight with wallpapers and widgets. These include Twitter and e-mail widgets that show your missives as they pop-up in real-time, without requiring you to open an app, like you would on the iPhone, for example.

You can also change your whole configuration, depending on your mood, by creating your own themes, known as 'scenes'. For example, you may want to look at your work calendar during the week, but avoid it at all costs during the weekend. Your 'weekend' scene might show your music-player widget instead. But the phone is also well set-up right out-of-

the-box, so you don't have to change anything if you don't want to.

The look 'n' feel

While the Android OS is flashy and oozing glitz, the HTC Tattoo is rather unassuming.

The phone has a matt-silver finish and feels rather chunky. It's compact, though, and it looks sleek—with HTC disposing off the trackball as seen on the Magic and Hero, and replacing it with a flat, circular, four-way navigational D-pad.

In all, there are seven buttons on the chassis, broken into five sections, with the aforementioned navigational button being the most prominent.

You would expect, then, that this would be the main button to wake up the phone from sleep. Anyone familiar with the Magic will know that's not how it works, however, when it comes to operating the Tattoo. Instead, you click the much smaller menu button twice to get into the main interface. To close things up, simply press the power button on the bottom right.

If you're underwhelmed by the HTC Tattoo's demure form, then

don't fret as the phone is all about individuality. HTC is releasing a number of funky cases with tattoo-like designs, so you can customise your handset. This is a good call on HTC's part, giving you the chance to choose your phone's style, rather than the company opting for a one-style-fits-all device.

When you flip the phone over (both the back and the front are customisable), what sticks out is the 3.2MP lens for the phone's camera. Unlike the Hero, which sported a small lens with a big 5 mega-pixel count, the lens on the HTC Tattoo sticks out like a sore thumb, surrounded by a chunky metallic border.

The only other things to note on the chassis are a 3.5mm headphone jack, a micro USB connector, and volume control on the left-hand side, which is pretty much flush with the chassis.

When it comes to what you get with the phone, there are hardly few things in the box, except for a charger (whip the three-pin plug off and you get your standard USB data cable for the mobile as well) and a headphone.